

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
The patient describes long-standing sadness, feelings of hopelessness, difficulty making decisions, worsening suicidal ideations, and includes significant symptoms that have worsened over the last 2 weeks, such as guilt, and issues with energy and concentration. This matches the profile of depression with a history of chronic or recurrent depression (double depression).

- Mania or psychosis are not described and do not fit the profile.
- Anhedonia is a symptom of depression but is not specifically mentioned as the primary issue.
- Paranoid personality disorder is characterized by a pervasive trust in others and fear of being deceived or betrayed, which does not match the described symptoms of depression.

The patient's long-term and recent exacerbation of symptoms, as well as their psychological state, best match the description of double depression.

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<answer>A. The patient is at risk for double depression.</answer>